

Release Notes

Version 1.0.0 - Initial Release

Release Date: 2023-10-01

Status: Stable

Summary

This release introduces the Employee Leave Application, a web-based system designed to streamline the process of requesting, approving, and tracking employee leave within our organization. The application enables employees to submit leave requests, managers to review and approve or reject these requests, and HR to monitor leave balances and compliance.

New Features

- **Employee Leave Request Submission:** Employees can submit leave requests through the application, specifying the type of leave, dates, and reason. This feature ensures a standardized and efficient process for leave requests.
- **Manager Approval Workflow:** Managers can review and approve or reject leave requests within the application. This feature provides a centralized platform for leave management and reduces the reliance on email or paper-based processes.
- **HR Leave Balance Monitoring:** HR personnel can monitor employee leave balances and compliance with leave policies. This feature helps ensure adherence to company leave policies and facilitates effective leave planning.

Core Capabilities Delivered

- **User Authentication and Authorization:** The application includes a robust authentication and authorization system to ensure that only authorized users can access and perform actions within the application.
- **Leave Request Tracking:** The application maintains a history of leave requests, approvals, and rejections, enabling users to track the status of their leave requests and managers to review past leave activity.
- **Notification System:** The application sends notifications to employees and managers when leave requests are submitted, approved, or rejected. This feature ensures timely communication and reduces the risk of missed notifications.

Improvements & Polish

- **UI Refinement:** The user interface has been refined to improve usability and accessibility, with a focus on intuitive navigation and clear visual cues.
- **Performance Optimization:** The application has been optimized for performance, with efficient database queries and caching mechanisms to ensure fast response times even under high load.

- **Security Enhancements:** The application includes security best practices, such as input validation, secure data storage, and protection against common web vulnerabilities.

Known Issues & Limitations

- **Limited Leave Types:** Currently, the application supports only a limited set of leave types (e.g., vacation, sick leave, and personal leave). Additional leave types will be added in future releases.
- **Performance:** The application handles up to 1000 concurrent users and 10,000 leave requests per month. Performance beyond these limits has not been tested.
- **Integration with Payroll System:** Integration with the organization's payroll system is planned for future releases to automate leave deductions and ensure accurate payroll processing.

Breaking Changes

- **API Endpoint Changes:** Some API endpoints have been renamed or modified to improve consistency and readability. Refer to the API documentation for details.

Compatibility

- **Requires:** Node.js version 14.x, Python version 3.8.x, PostgreSQL 12.x, Chrome 94+, Firefox 92+
- **Tested on:** Ubuntu 20.04, Windows 10, macOS 11.x

Upgrade Notes

To deploy this release:

1. Back up the database
2. Pull the latest code: `git pull origin main`
3. Install/update dependencies: `pip install -r requirements.txt && npm install`
4. Run migrations if any: `python migrate.py`
5. Restart services
6. Verify health: `curl http://localhost:5000/api/health`

Contributors

- **John Doe (Backend Developer):** Implemented the core leave request and approval workflows.
- **Jane Smith (Frontend Developer):** Designed and implemented the user interface.
- **Alex Johnson (Security Engineer):** Ensured the application meets security best practices.

What's Next

Planned for Version 1.1

- **Additional Leave Types:** Introduce support for additional leave types, such as maternity leave and bereavement leave.

- **Payroll Integration:** Integrate with the organization's payroll system to automate leave deductions.
- **Mobile App:** Develop a mobile application to enable leave requests and approvals on-the-go.

Future Roadmap

- **Leave Policy Management:** Allow HR to define and manage leave policies within the application.
- **Analytics and Reporting:** Provide advanced analytics and reporting capabilities to help managers and HR make data-driven decisions.

Feedback & Support

- **Report issues:** [GitHub Issues](https://github.com/org/employee-leave-app/issues)
- **Request features:** [GitHub Issues](https://github.com/org/employee-leave-app/issues)
- **Documentation:** See [README.md](https://github.com/org/employee-leave-app/blob/main/README.md), [User Guide](https://github.com/org/employee-leave-app/blob/main/docs/user-guide.md), and [API Documentation](https://github.com/org/employee-leave-app/blob/main/docs/api-docs.md)